

TELECOM MARKET INTELLIGENCE — MONTHLY PULSE

# Serbia Telecommunications Market

June 2026 — Competitive Intensity Brief

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**Run date:** 2026-06-09

**Operators covered:** Telekom Srbija (mts), Yettel Serbia, A1 Serbia

**Research window:** Last 90 days (baseline refresh: 18 months)

## Year So Far

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The defining event of 2026's opening is the December 2025 simultaneous 5G launch by all three operators, following a tightly-priced spectrum auction where each paid just over €100 million. The competitive axis has shifted from coverage claims to 5G upsell and customer acquisition via number porting, where A1 Serbia has taken a consistent lead in both Q4 2025 and Q1 2026 despite holding the smallest subscriber base. Telekom Srbija's financial dominance is unchallenged, but it is the consistent net loser in porting flows.

## Last 90 Days

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### DIRECTIONAL VERDICT

**Intensifying — A1's consistent porting gains and Yettel's network quality award are both sharpening competitive pressure on the dominant incumbent, while mandatory 5G rollout obligations will force heavier capex and promotional investment from all three through year-end.**

- **Pricing — tariff discipline** — All three MNOs have raised entry-level tariffs only once since 2022 despite inflation; the pattern continues in early 2026 with no operator breaking ranks on headline price cuts or aggressive discounting. ([Mordor Intelligence / Prepaid SIM Wiki, 2026](#))
- **Unlimited data** — Yettel is most aggressive on unlimited data positioning, offering unlimited postpaid plans from RSD 450–3,400/month and a prepaid eSIM unlimited tier; A1 competes with large-bucket bundles (100 GB/10 days tourist eSIM at RSD 1,000) rather than true unlimited framing. ([Yettel.rs tariff page, 2026](#))
- **Number porting — A1 momentum** — A1 Serbia led MNP gains in both Q4 2025 (21,487 net) and Q1 2026 (17,133 net); Telekom Srbija was the largest net loser in Q1 2026 (–19,641), suggesting A1's promotional and retail execution is outperforming despite its third-place market share position. ([Telecompaper, 2026-05](#))
- **Telekom Srbija financials** — Record 2025 revenue of EUR 2.3 billion (consolidated) and EUR 1.3 billion operating profit; Serbian operations alone contributed EUR 1.65 billion revenue and EUR 960 million EBIT. CEO projects

net profit exceeding EUR 300 million in 2026 on Q1 momentum. ([SeeNews / Tanjug, 2026-02](#))

- **Network quality — Yettel leads** — An independent umlaut "Best in Test" certificate (W39 2025–W10 2026 data) awarded Yettel the highest overall network score at 911/1000, ahead of mts and A1. This gives Yettel a credible quality narrative heading into 5G upsell season. ([Umlaut/Yettel Serbia, 2026](#))
- **5G rollout obligations** — RATEL requires all three operators to deploy a minimum of 200 5G base stations by December 2026 and 1,000 by 2027, with mandatory coverage of 22 cities and key corridors; Belgrade Expo 2027 site is a named obligation, raising the stakes for coverage races heading into late 2026. ([EC Digital Strategy / Spectrum-Tracker, 2025-12](#))

## Outlook to Year-End

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- **5G coverage race** — All operators must hit 200-station deployment by December 2026; whichever operator reaches urban saturation first (likely Telekom Srbija on financial firepower) will push rivals into defensive pricing or bundle upsells, probably by Q3 2026.
- **A1 porting trajectory** — If A1 sustains Q1 2026 porting pace through Q2–Q3, it could break above 26–27% market share by year-end, forcing Yettel and Telekom Srbija into retention-focused tariff responses; risk is A1's weaker network score limits stickiness.
- **Telekom Srbija profitability vs. investment** — CEO's EUR 300 million net profit target for 2026 implies continued cost discipline, but 5G capex and potential retail counter-response to porting losses could compress margins in H2; no earnings warning signals yet.

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### Sources

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Telekom Srbija ends 2025 with EUR 1.3 billion operating profit — [Telecompaper, 2026-02](#)

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